

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMMON COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR
GROUP 'B' NON-GAZETTED (TECHNICAL) EXAMINATION
UNDER HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM,
(JANUARY-2026)

PAPER-I (GENERAL ENGLISH)

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART - A (Multiple Choice Questions) (50 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10): Identify the Parts of Speech of the underlined words:

1. Let us go up the hill
(a) Verb (b) Adjective
(c) Preposition (d) Conjunction
2. There is little danger in going there
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun
3. We went out after they had left
(a) Preposition (b) Conjunction
(c) Verb (d) Noun
4. I was young once
(a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Verb (d) Adverb
5. He dare not tell a lie
(a) Verb (b) Noun
(c) Adjective (d) Interjection
6. The necklace is made of gold
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Pronoun (d) Noun
7. Hush, don't make a noise
(a) Conjunction (b) Interjection
(c) Preposition (d) Adjective
8. You can ask either of them
(a) Adjective (b) Preposition
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun

9. He was sitting close beside her
(a) Adverb (b) Adjective
(c) Preposition (d) Noun
10. The show had come to a close
(a) Adjective (b) Noun
(c) Adverb (d) Preposition

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 15): Choose the correct Preposition to fill in the blanks:

11. He rules _____ a vast empire
(a) over (b) about
(c) on (d) beside
12. There is a garden _____ the house
(a) down (b) from
(c) besides (d) behind
13. He was brought _____ the magistrate
(a) under (b) without
(c) before (d) into
14. The power went out _____ the storm
(a) during (b) about
(c) for (d) along
15. She was accused _____ her friend
(a) by (b) for
(c) of (d) from

Direction (Question Nos. 16 - 25): Correct the underlined phrases if needed, by choosing from the given options:

16. She drives her car at eighty miles each hour
(a) an hour (b) hourly
(c) every hour (d) No Correction required
17. I gave my niece a children's very colourfully illustrated encyclopedia
(a) a very colourfully illustrated children's encyclopedia
(b) a child's very colourfully illustrated encyclopedia
(c) an illustrated child's very colourful encyclopedia
(d) No Correction required
18. Nearly everyone suffers when unemployment rises
(a) Everyone nearly (b) Nearly all
(c) Nearly each one (d) No Correction required
19. Did you know when shall he be leaving for Delhi?
(a) should he be left (b) would he have left
(c) he would be leaving (d) No Correction required

20. The alarming report of the building collapse made everyone frightened
(a) alarmed report (b) alarmed reporting
(c) reported alarm (d) No Correction required
21. Because it was a stormy night, he dare not to go out in the dark
(a) dared not go (b) dare not went
(c) dared not to have gone (d) No Correction required
22. The donation amount was such that as I was expected him to donate
(a) so that as I expected (b) such as that I expect
(c) such that I expected of (d) No Correction required
23. For want of financial resources, he was unable to have continued his studies
(a) unable to continue (b) unable to have continue
(c) unable to be continued (d) No Correction required
24. He is less likely to win unless he practiced rigorously and regularly
(a) until he practiced (b) unless he practices
(c) unless he practice (d) No Correction required
25. The document is concerning your health and that of your family
(a) concerns with (b) is concerned with
(c) concerns (d) No Correction required

Direction (Question Nos. 26 - 35): Choose the correct pair of words to form meaningful sentences:

26. He had managed to _____ several times, but was finally _____ by the police
(a) deceive, cheated (b) escape, arrested
(c) defend, acquitted (d) cheat, robbed
27. We cannot _____ such an _____ act of violence
(a) tolerate, insipid (b) neglect, insignificant
(c) consider, important (d) pardon, outrageous
28. The activities of the association have _____ from the _____ objectives set for it in the initial years
(a) details, grand (b) increased, party
(c) deviated, original (d) emerged, impaired
29. The speech _____ with subtle threats has resulted in _____ tension in the sensitive areas of the city
(a) started, disclosed (b) full, demanding
(c) replete, increased (d) forced, presented
30. We can _____ to travel by air, but we _____ train journey
(a) spend, enjoy (b) afford, prefer
(c) decide, commute (d) decide, undertook
31. The chief _____ him of his administrative powers and _____ him to the Bahamas
(a) divested, deported (b) inversted, shipped
(c) augmented, deported\ (d) incremented, sent
32. Like the _____ part of an iceberg, much of what is interesting in the city is not _____
(a) inner, authentic (b) submerged, visible
(c) upper, viable (d) greater, official

33. The _____ of democratic freedom is dialogue and the _____ interchange of diverse ideas
(a) deterioration, condoned (b) height, restrained
(c) essence, unhampered (d) alienation, compulsory
34. Even as _____ machines free men from drudgery, they _____ displace men from jobs
(a) automated, simultaneously (b) robotlike, unwillingly
(c) animated, honestly (d) accelerated, seemingly
35. To cross the river means to take a final _____ step which may have dangerous _____
(a) hazardous, precedent (b) unwarranted, potentialities
(c) well-considered (d) irrevocable, consequences

Direction (Question Nos. 36 - 40): Choose the correct antonym of the words given:

36. Benevolent
(a) Kind (b) Cruel
(c) Ugly (d) Compassionate
37. Vivid
(a) Dull (b) Bright
(c) Graphic (d) Changeable
38. Audacious
(a) Bold (b) Cowardly
(c) Creative (d) Lazy
39. Lucid
(a) Confusing (b) Intelligible
(c) Transparent (d) Fruitful
40. Gregarious
(a) Sociable (b) Introverted
(c) Obscure (d) Aggressive

Direction (Question Nos. 41 - 50): Choose the correct answer:

41. The idiom 'once in a blue moon' means-
(a) Very often (b) Rarely
(c) At night (d) Quickly
42. If someone 'hits the nail on the head,' they:
(a) Hurt themselves (b) Are very angry
(c) Say or do something exactly right (d) Start an argument
43. The idiom 'the ball is in your court' means-
(a) You are playing a game (b) You have lost
(c) It is your turn to act or decide (d) You are winning
44. The phrase 'under the weather' means
(a) Feeling cold (b) Feeling sick
(c) Feeling happy (d) Feeling angry

45. Choose the option that best explains the idiom, 'to throw down the gauntlet.'
- (a) To withdraw from a responsibility
 - (b) To accept a difficult situation unwillingly
 - (c) To issue a direct challenge, often boldly or defiantly
 - (d) To resolve a long-standing conflict peacefully
46. Which type of sentence makes a statement?
- (a) Interrogative
 - (b) Imperative
 - (c) Declarative
 - (d) Exclamatory
47. Identify the type of sentence:
'Susan is going to Church.'
- (a) Imperative
 - (b) Interrogative
 - (c) Exclamatory
 - (d) Declarative
48. 'How beautiful the sunset is!' is a:
- (a) Declarative Sentence
 - (b) Imperative Sentence
 - (c) Interrogative Sentence
 - (d) Exclamatory Sentence
49. Which of the following is an Imperative Sentence?
- (a) He likes ice-cream
 - (b) Are you ready?
 - (c) Shut the window
 - (d) What a lovely day!
50. Identify the type of sentence:
'Could you possibly explain why the meeting was postponed?'
- (a) Imperative
 - (b) Interrogative with imperative force
 - (c) Exclamatory
 - (d) Declarative

PART- B (Conventional Type) (50 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the **Answer Sheet** provided.*

Marks for each question is indicated against it.

1. Read the following passage carefully and write a precis in about one third of its length. Suggest a suitable title. (10)

In the United States, they have opened their first rehabilitation centre for Internet Addicts. De-addiction camps in China were in the news recently for the death of a teenager because of the brutal methods used to cure 'Internet Addiction' (IA). Our country must seriously think about such centres that help de-addict compulsive Internet-users, both young and old.

IA for now is a catch-all term that not only stands for addiction to specific activities such as gambling or gaming, but also refers to longer hours devoted to the computer network at the expense of other activities. Though, the Internet is only a medium of communication and information transmission and retrieval (like the printed book or television), 'addiction' is being used in this case with concern because of a fundamental dialectic: 'quantity becomes quality.'

A whole new world is just a click away with the Internet. It is a medium just like books and television, but the amount of interaction it makes possible with others, sometimes replacing the need for real world interaction, makes it vastly different. Educators, neuroscientists and those others having public health concerns in all developing and developed countries have woken upto this reality.

According to expert neuropsychiatric opinion, IA is somewhere between Obsessive Compulsive Disorder and the addiction due to substance abuse. Substance abuse led addiction focuses on gratification, which this form of attachment provides, though there is no chemical ingestion.

At the same time, the behavioural modifications are similar to those with Obsessive Compulsive Disorder. It is almost like the 'rush' gamblers get out of a purely gratification-oriented repetitive action.

2. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

The Scandinavian countries are much admired all over the world for their enlightened social policies. Sweden has evolved an excellent system for protecting the individual citizen from high-handed or incompetent public officers. The system has worked so well that it has been adopted in other countries like Denmark, Norway, Finland and New Zealand. Even countries with large populations are now seriously considering imitating the Swedes.

The Swedes were the first to recognize that Public officials like civil servants, police officers, health inspectors or tax collectors can make mistakes or act overzealously in the belief that they are serving the public. As long ago as 1809, the Swedish Parliament introduced a scheme to safeguard the interests of the individual. A parliamentary committee representing all political parties appoints a person who is suitably qualified to investigate private grievances against the State. The official title of the person is Justice Ombudsman but Swedes commonly refer to him as the J.O. or just Ombudsman.

The Ombudsman is not subject to political pressure. He investigates complaints, large and small, that come to him from all levels of society. As complaints must be made in writing, the Ombudsman receives an average of 1200 letters a year. He has eight lawyer assistants to help him, and he examines every single letter in detail. There is nothing secretive about the Ombudsman's work, for his correspondence is open to public inspection. If a citizen's complaint is justified, the Ombudsman will act on his behalf. The action he takes varies according to the nature of the complaint. He may gently reprimand an official or even suggest to parliament that a law be altered. The following case is a typical example of the Ombudsman's work.

A foreigner living in a Swedish village wrote to the Ombudsman, complaining that he had been ill-treated by the police, simply because he was a foreigner. The Ombudsman immediately wrote to the Chief

of Police in the district, asking him to send a record of the case.

There was nothing in the record to show that the foreigner's complaint was justified and the Chief of Police stoutly denied the accusation. It was impossible for the Ombudsman to take action on the complaint, but when he received a similar complaint from another foreigner in the same village, he immediately sent one of his lawyers to investigate. The lawyer ascertained that a policeman had indeed dealt roughly with foreigners on several occasions. The fact that the policeman was prejudiced against foreigners could not be recorded in the official files. It was possible only for the Ombudsman to find this out by sending one of his representatives to check the facts on the spot. The policeman in question was severely reprimanded and was informed that if any further complaints were received against him, he would be prosecuted. The Ombudsman's prompt action in the manner at once put an end to an unpleasant practice which might have gone on unnoticed.

I. Find similar meanings of the following words from the above passage: (5×1=5)

- (a) with too much or undesired enthusiasm
- (b) rebuke somebody officially
- (c) obliged to obey
- (d) strongly
- (e) dislike based on fear or false information

II. Answer the following questions:

- (a) Why did Sweden introduce the institution of Ombudsman? (1)
- (b) How is an Ombudsman chosen in Sweden? (1)
- (c) How does the Ombudsman investigate and act upon the citizen's complaints? (2)
- (d) How can the public find out about Ombudsman's work? (2)
- (e) What did the Chief of Police deny? (2)
- (f) How did the Ombudsman decide the case? (2)

3. There is a flood of advertisements on newspapers, television and social media these days. Useless commodities and superstitious beliefs are promoted through glamorous and exaggerated presentations. Write a letter to the Editor of 'The Mizoram Express' signing yourself as XYZ of ABC Locality in Aizawl expressing about the negative influence such advertisements have on the minds of the people. (15)

4. Change the Voice: (5×1=5)

- (a) Someone stole my bag yesterday.
- (b) The company is launching a new product next month.
- (c) He will have completed the task before noon.
- (d) People speak English all over the world.
- (e) The famous singer has sung a beautiful song to the audience.

5. Rewrite the sentences in Direct/Indirect Speech: (5×1=5)

- (a) He said, 'I may not attend the meeting.'
- (b) She said to him, 'Are you working on this project alone?'
- (c) She said, 'I have a new book.'
- (d) She requested him to help her carry those boxes.
- (e) Sangi said that she would help me.